CS3003: IT Project Management

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Part 8: Fundamentals of Team Management

Team Management Fundamentals

Subject groups	Process groups				
	Initiating	Planning	Implementing	Controlling	Closing
Integration	4.3.2 Develop project charter	4.3.3 Develop project plans	4.3.4 Direct project work	4.3.5 Control project work 4.3.6 Control changes	4.3.7 Close project phase or project 4.3.8 Collect lessons learned
Stakeholder	4.3.9 Identify stakeholders		4.3.10 Manage stakeholders		
Scope		4.3.11 Define scope 4.3.12 Create work breakdown structure 4.3.13 Define activities		4.3.14 Control scope	
Resource	4.3.15 Establish project team	4.3.16 Estimate resources 4.3.17 Define project organization	4.3.18 Develop project team	4.3.19 Control resources 4.3.20 Manage project team	
Time		4.3.21 Sequence activities 4.3.22 Estimate activity durations 4.3.23 Develop schedule		4.3.24 Control schedule	
Cost		4.3.25 Estimate costs 4.3.26 Develop budget		4.3.27 Control costs	
Risk		4.3.28 Identify risks 4.3.29 Assess risks	4.3.30 Treat risks	4.3.31 Control risks	
Quality		4.3.32 Plan quality	4.3.33 Perform quality assurance	4.3.34 Perform quality control	
Procurement		4.3.35 Plan procurements	4.3.36 Select suppliers	4.3.37 Administer procurements	
Communication		4.3.38 Plan communications	4.3.39 Distribute information	4.3.40 Manage communications	

NOTE The purpose of this table is not to specify a chronological order for carrying out the activities. Its purpose is to map subject groups and process groups.

Team Management Fundamentals

(ISO21500): Develop project team purpose is to improve the performance and interaction of team members in a continuing manner. This process should enhance team motivation and performance. The purpose of **Manage project team** is to optimize team performance, provide feedback, resolve issues, encourage communication and coordinate changes, in order to achieve project success.
These also depend on the process of actually establishing the Project Team.

But what is a Team? Many definitions, e.g.:
"*A (small) number of people who are committed to a common purpose and who are working together and interdependently to achieve specific performance goals using an approach for which they hold themselves accountable*."

Given that IT Projects are predominantly made by teams of people and their outcomes are used by people, Team Management (or better Leadership) is probably the *most critical success* factor!

Team Management Fundamentals

Contents

1. Main Characteristics of effective project teams and reasons that teams fail
2. Tuckman Model of Stages of Team/Group development
3. Leadership Styles
4. Basics of Goal-Setting
5. Time Management
6. Meetings Management
7. Conflict Management

During the lectures, we will be discussing Good Practices and Rules of Thumb in managing IT Project Teams.

Team Management Fundamentals

Main Characteristics of effective Project Teams

1. A clear sense of Mission

People work better if they know how their performance contributes to achieving an objective. Do not use "mushroom management" (keep them in the dark) or give them isolated/fragmented tasks without informing on the overall status of the project.
It is crucial to invest time to clarify roles and define concrete goals right from the beginning of the project.

2. A Productive Interdependency

Developing a holistic sense of appreciation for the strengths and contribution of each team member to the project success.

3. Cohesiveness

Degree of mutual "attraction" that team members hold for one another and their tasks

4. Trust

5. Enthusiasm

6. Results Orientation

You can't expect the team to have such characteristics if you, as the PM, do not have them!

Team Management Fundamentals

Some reasons that Project Teams fail

1. **Unclear mission & project/individual goals** (fragmented, constantly changing, poorly communicated)
2. **Poorly defined roles and responsibilities**
3. **Lack of Motivation** (e.g. project perceived as unnecessary, or as of “low priority”)
4. **Poor Communication**
5. **“Groupthink”**
6. **Poor Leadership** (to be discussed later)
7. **Disruptive Behavior** of team members

Team Management Fundamentals

1. Tuckman Model of (Maturity) Stages of Team/Group development

Stage	Characteristics
Forming	Team members get to know each other and establish team ground rules, roles and responsibilities. People are often apprehensive, reserved and exhibit low trust. Attitudes of Excitement, Anticipation, Anxiety, Questioning.
Storming	Team member begin to resist authority and rules, demonstrate hidden agendas and bias, test the limits and constraints placed in the their behaviour. Norms of work and interpersonal behaviors are challenged. Attitudes of Resistance to Change, Defensiveness, Tension. Team members may clash over control, break into opposing sub groups, withdraw from group interaction. Conflicts exist.
Norming	Team members agree on operating procedures (even adapted) and seek to work together. Collaboration, Communication, Commitment and Cohesiveness.
Performing	The group members work together effectively and focus on accomplishing their tasks. Increased Trust, Confidence, Optimism, Creativity.
Adjourning	Team disperses and members move onto other projects. Positive feeling about teamwork and a sense of accomplishment.

The Project Leader can: establish, collectively (and early) ground rules (operational/behavioural) balance participation, clearly define roles & responsibilities. Kick-off meeting is very important!

The Project Leader can: Facilitate dialogue, facilitate decision making, resolve conflict, keep team focused on project goals.

The Project Leader can: Delegate more responsibility, encourage expression of ideas provide recognition and training.

The Project Leader can: suggest new goals, test assumptions, encourage reflection and continuous improvement processes.

The Project Leader can: Reward, conduct final Lessons Learned sessions, Celebrate with the Team.

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Team Management Fundamentals: Leadership Styles

- What is Leaderhip?….no unique definition
- What is your definition of leadership?
- Everyone is a Leader….
- Leadership Vs Management
- Importance of Vision, Communication and ability to Motivate

Team Management Fundamentals: Leadership Styles

- **Situational Leadership:** the adoption of an adaptive approach in which the leader is flexible in order to suit his/her leadership style to the specifics of the context.
- Situational Leadership has been adopted by most modern organizations.
- “Leader as the boss” belongs to the past….
- **Main Models of Situational Leadership**
  - Blanchard and Hersey
  - D. Goleman

Team Management Fundamentals: Leadership Styles

- **Situational Leadership:** Blanchard and Hersey Model

Style	Characteristics
S1: **Telling /Directing**	Implies specific guidance and close supervision. Leader makes decision, communicates it and expects that it will be performed. A "do this" position with clear required actions to be performed. *When to use:* Followers of Low Competence, Low Commitment (Unable or unwilling or not confident). Leader focus: High on Task, Low on Relationship. An effective approach in crisis management.
S2: **Selling /Coaching**	Implies explaining and persuading ("sell"). Leader is open to suggestions/opinion. Spends time listening/advising and even helping/coaching. *When to use:* Followers of Low/Some Competence but High Commitment (Unable but willing or confident or motivated). Leader focus: High on Task, High on Relationship
S3: **Participating /Supporting**	Both leader and followers participate in the decision-making process. Emphasis on motivating and supporting followers (share and facilitate). *When to use:* Followers of High Competence but Low/Some Commitment (Able but unwilling or not confident or not motivated). Leader focus: Low on Task, High on Relationship
S4: **Observing /Delegating**	Let others do it. Leader provides minimum guidance or just helps to solve problems. The team decides and the leader may occasionally be asked to participate in decision-making. *When to use:* Followers of High Competence and High Commitment (Able and willing and confident and motivated). Leader focus: Low on Task, Low on Relationship

Team Management Fundamentals: Leadership Styles

- **Situational Leadership: D. Goleman Model**

Style	Characteristics
Coaching Leaders	Focus is on helping others in their personal development as well as job-related skills/activities. The leader ensures that people have the knowledge and tools to get their job done. This style works best with people who know their limitations/weaknesses and are open to new ideas, improvement and change.
Pacesetting Leaders	The leader sets very high expectations and performance standards for themselves and their group. The leader leads by example (e.g. exemplifies the behaviors that are sought from other members of the group). This style should be used sparingly, since groups/people can "burn out" due to the demanding pace of this approach.
Democratic Leaders	Leaders give members of the group a vote or say in almost all decisions. When used effectively, the style can build flexibility and responsibility and help identify new ideas. Can be very time consuming because of the level of involvement in the decision-making process, hence, it may not be the best style if tight deadlines have to be met.
Affiliative Leaders	Leaders put team members first. This style is used when morale is low or in team-building. The leader uses praise and helpfulness to build up the team's confidence.
Authoritative Leaders	Leaders who are very good in analysing/dealing with the problems and challenges at hand, and they can clearly identify goals that will lead to success. Will typically allow group members to help figure out how to best solve a problem.
Coercive Leaders	"Command and control" style of telling others what to do. Requires a very clear vision of the result and how to best achieve it. To be used with caution as it undermines group members motivation.

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Team Management Fundamentals: Goal Setting

Goal Setting: a process in which a person or group defines what they aim and commit to achieve (based on individual and/or team effort)

- Types: Personal Vs Departmental/Project/Organizational Goals
- Short-term Vs Long-term
- Critical Vs Enabling Vs Nice-To-Have
  - Critical (your success depends on these)
  - Enabling: create a more desirable business context or take advantage of a business opportunity. They are important, but accomplish a better business environment over the long term rather than keep you or your business on track and successful.
  - Nice-to-Have: These goals make improvements that enhance your day-to-day or your business. They usually relate to making activities faster or easier.
- Qualitative Vs Quantitative
- Top Down Vs Bottom Up
- **Alignment of the various Goals is crucial** (implies choice, prioritization, concrete action-setting, monitoring/reflection/adaptation)

Team Management Fundamentals: Goal Setting

Goal Setting: SMART criteria to guide Goal Setting

- Widely used worldwide (with some variations on the meaning of some of the letters in the acronym).

  S: *Specific*

  M: *Measurable*

  A: *Achievable*

  R: *Realistic (Relevant)*

  T: *Time-limited*

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Team Management Fundamentals: Time Management

Time Management. A generic definition: the method/approach/way applied to organize and plan how long you spend (and when) on specific activities.

- Time Management is directly related to Goal Setting!
- Requires discipline and practice!. A generic framework of actions:
  i. Identify your Critical/Enabling/Nice-To-Have Goals and split them to tasks. For each task, identify the time to be completed and its priority and document it, e.g. <task, time, priority>. Priorities are directly aligned to goals e.g. Priority A (Critical), Priority B (Enabling), Priority C (Nice-To-Have).
  ii. Analyse the activities that you spent your time on. How relevant are they to your critical goals? Compare “actual time spent” Vs “should had spent”. Identify your bad practices in time management.
  iii. Plan your activities Vs time (daily, weekly, longer-term). A number of tools/methods may be of help. Focus on your critical goals.
  iv. Observe, reflect, improve.

Team Management Fundamentals: Time Management

Best Practices

1. Goals alignment, breakdown to Tasks, Planning, Logging/Analysing, Observe/Reflect/Improve (see previous slide)
2. Keep a “To-Do” List and a Schedule (with some free time to allow for flexibility/unexpected events)
3. Develop some habits that boost your efficiency
4. Avoid procrastination and reward yourself for achieving goals. It’s always better to start a task…
5. Avoid destructions and interruptions. Focus!
6. Take breaks! (to refresh your mind)
7. Delegate.
8. Learn to say “No”.
9. Mentor colleagues to bring you problems accompanied with proposals for solutions. Not merely problems!
10. Prioritize (first things first) (e.g. quadrant of Urgent Vs Important tasks/activities)
11. Consult others on their practices and make sure you respect their time!
12. Manage your Energy!

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Team Management Fundamentals: Meetings Management

There exist various types of meetings, e.g. to share information, to resolve a problem, to make decisions. In most cases, there are a number of Questions and **Best Practices** that are applicable.

Before the Meeting

- **"To call or not to call"**?
- An **appropriately designed Agenda** is a key success factor (should include sufficient time, appropriate venue, well defined goals and concrete items with designated time)
- **Who to invite?** (power to decide, have required info, have a role/interest in the topic, should be aware of outcomes/facts to be presented, may be assigned actions)
- **How many shall I invite?** (if you have to resolve a problem or make a decision more than 8 participants may be an issue)
- **Organize and test the meeting venue conditions in advance!**
- **Prepare yourself in advance** (relevant documents/facts, communicate agenda and background material beforehand, inform your boss or others who will not attend but are interested)
- **Decide on "How shall we decide"?** (majority, unanimous, leader?) Which is better?

Team Management Fundamentals: Meetings Management

During the Meeting

- Start at the time scheduled. Do not wait!
- If people do not know each other, allow time to introduce themselves
- The first action is to remind the topic, goals and the agenda items (and allow for possible reasonable adaptations)
- Discuss/decide any applicable rules (e.g. how to decide, timings, who will speak, decide on breaks in long meetings)
- Follow the agenda, do not allow irrelevant topics. Focus!
- Facilitate/encourage participation and consensus, ask questions, be the “devils advocate”, exercise “Active Listening”, regularly provide a synopsis of what has been discussed/decided.
- Build on positive aspects or items of agreement to continue.
- Do not permit interruptions or somebody dominating. Prevent/disallow interpersonal conflicts or disruptive behavior.
- Use the board to keep notes and highlight key points (but do not exaggerate)
- Keep track of time and progress to ensure the meeting is on-track. Try to finish on-time or ask permission if you wish to extend.
- Before the end, summarize what has been decided and make sure there are decision and action items/plan, with clear responsibilities, schedules and review mechanisms!

After the Meeting

- Communicate appropriate Meeting Minutes in a timely manner.
- Reflect on your practices and aim to improve. If necessary, ask relevant participants on their views.

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Team Management Fundamentals: Conflict Management

- **Conflict Definition:** "a *process*, that begins when you *perceive* that someone has frustrated or is about to frustrate a major concern of yours". Two important elements:
  - It is a process, not a state, i.e. it evolves!
  - It is perceptual, i.e. the parties involved "perceive"!
- **3 main Categories**
  - **Goal-oriented conflicts –** disagreements about results, performance criteria, objectives, priorities, etc. Such conflicts often originate from multiple perceptions of the project which stem from vague goals which trigger different individual interpretations.
  - **Administrative conflicts –** arise through management hierarchy, structures and company philosophy. Such conflicts are often centered on disagreements around authority/responsibility (e.g. project tasks, decisions)
  - **Interpersonal conflict –** due to personality differences, sources may include behavioural styles, egos, ethics, personality traits, bias etc.
- **3 Schools of Thought:** Traditional, Behavioural, Interactionist

Slide material based on J. Pinto's book, "Project Management", Chapter 6.

Team Management Fundamentals: Conflict Management

Numerous Sources of conflict, for example:

- Competition of scarce resources
- Organizational reward systems
- Uncertainty over lines of authority
- Departmental mindsets and agendas
- Violations of group or organizational norms
- Disagreements over goals and means to achieve them
- Faulty attributions
- Personal Fears and Biases
- Faulty Communication.
- ….

Slide material based on J. Pinto's book, "Project Management", Chapter 6.

Team Management Fundamentals: Conflict Management

Main methods of Resolving Conflict

1. Mediate	Directly and actively seek to find a solution. Options of “defusion” Vs examining underlying causes. Requires working with both parties to come to a common agreement.
2. Arbitrate	Impose a judgement after listening to both positions. Beware not to make interpersonal judgement – put emphasis on facts and on the judgement itself.
3. Control	Not all conflicts should be quickly resolved. A pragmatic response may be to wait for some time until parties cool down. Then intervene.
4. Accept	Do nothing. Remember that sometimes by intervening, you may have a worse result. Sometimes one may not know the full story (or history).
5. Eliminate	Remove conflicting party or parties from the project.

Slide material based on J. Pinto’s book, “Project Management”, Chapter 6.

Team Management Fundamentals: Conflict Management

Best Practices

1. Conflict is natural – it may even be an evidence of progress (but there is a limit).
2. Different “resolution” approaches are appropriate in different situations.
3. No interference may be a good approach – its not about being “lazy”. In any case, carefully *Plan* the way to intervene.
4. Learn to deal with your own conflicts and emotions constructively (in order to deal effectively with other people conflicts).
5. Dealing with human emotions is usually more effective than rational argumentation.
6. Important to achieve that each party strives to experience “reality” using the other party’s “lenses” and to focus on the other party’s emotions and concerns.
7. Encourage “Active Listening”.
8. 5-Why analysis. Beware of faulty assumptions and explore underlying motives. Accept and explore the possibility that something that you (as PM) do (or do not do) may be the source of the conflict.
9. Better to strive for Collaborative “Win-Win” solutions.